AI AGENTS · SALES DEVELOPMENT

Cold emails a free model can write, *and the checks that decide whether they go out.*

· Julian Batto-Hokson · Real run · fictional prospects · Python · CrewAI · Ollama · pytest · October 2026

Scope note: the product ("Ledgerline", an accounts payable tool) and both prospects are fictional, so no real person's name or details are in the repo. The drafts below are real, unedited model output. Nothing is ever sent automatically.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Cold email fails in predictable ways: too long, no clear ask, a made-up stat about the prospect, an opener that reads like a template. Each of those can be checked in code. This tool has a CrewAI researcher pick one angle from the prospect's notes, a writer draft the email, and plain Python checks run on every draft before it's saved. A failing draft goes back with the exact problems; after two retries it's saved marked FLAGGED for a rep to fix.

On a real run with qwen2.5 (7B), both drafts passed every check on the first attempt in 2 minutes 41 seconds total, at no model cost. Reading them as a rep would, each still needed one fix the checks can't see, which is why the output is a review file, not a send.

2 / 2	2m41s	11	7
Drafts passed every check on attempt 1	For the batch on 2 CPUs, $0 model cost	Checks per draft, all in plain Python	Offline tests, no model needed

0

Emails sent automatically, by design

REAL RUN

What the drafts looked like

01 Dana Whitfield, Controller at Northbeam Outdoor (fictional)

Notes given to the model: posted on LinkedIn that month-end close takes 9 days; hiring an AP specialist.

```
Subject: Streamline Month-End Closings with Ledgerline

Hello Dana,

I noticed you posted that month-end close at Northbeam Outdoor takes 9 days. Our
Ledgerline solution automates accounts payable, which can help reduce this process
time. Could I share more details on how we've helped other companies streamline their
month-end close?

Best,
Alex
```

WHAT THE CHECKS CONFIRMED

Subject under 7 words, body under 120, the company named, the "9 days" figure taken from her notes, exactly one question, no template opener, no banned words.

WHAT A REP WOULD STILL FIX

"How we've helped other companies" hints at customer stories the product sheet doesn't contain. The prompt says never to invent customers; the model implied them instead, and a text check can't catch an implication.

02 Marcus Oyelaran, VP Finance at Tidewater Clinics (fictional)

Notes: opened 3 new clinic locations this year; a job post mentions consolidating vendor payments. The draft passed, but it said the company is "focused on streamlining operations across multiple locations", which is vaguer than the fact it was given, and closed with a weak ask ("Have you considered this solution?").

03 A fix carried over from the resume tailor

A real run of my AI Resume Tailor showed that "leveraging" could slip past a banned list containing "leverage", and that "[Company Name]" placeholders weren't checked. Both projects share the banned list, so the same fix and a test were added here.

DESIGN

How it works

```
Account Researcher ──> Outbound Email Writer ──> guards ──┬─ pass ──> output/drafts.md + drafts.csv
  (one angle from the notes)   (subject + body)           └─ fail ──> retry with feedback (max 2), then FLAGGED
```

Check	What it catches
Invented numbers	Any figure not in the prospect notes or product sheet ("15-minute call" is allowed)
Personalization	The body never names the prospect's company
One ask	Exactly one question
Template opener	"My name is...", "I hope this email finds you well" and similar
Length	Subject over 7 words, body over 120 words
Style	Em dashes, exclamation points, banned words and their variants, placeholders

TECHNICAL REFERENCE

Setup and scope

Dimension	Value
Framework	CrewAI, one sequential crew per prospect
Model	Ollama qwen2.5:7b by default (free, local); Claude via one env var
Input	CSV of name, title, company, notes, plus a product sheet
Output	drafts.md for reading, drafts.csv with status, attempts and problems
Not measured	Reply rates, which need real sends and a comparison group
Tools	Python, CrewAI, Ollama, pytest